Digital Advice Program

Steering committee brief, prepared by the Strategy Office of Northwind Financial (a fictional company used for testing). Draft for discussion, June 2026.

What we need: a steering committee deck of about 10 to 12 slides that sets out the strategy for the Digital Advice Program, shows where the client journey breaks today, and lays out the delivery plan and governance for the next three months. Open with the answer. The audience is the executive steering committee.

1. Why this matters now

Clients increasingly start their banking and investing decisions online, but most still finish them with a person. Today only 18% of our product sales are completed digitally, against an industry leader benchmark of 34%. Our digital channels generate strong interest but lose clients at the point where they need help: 42% of clients who start a digital application and ask for support never complete it.

At the same time, demand for advice is growing. Requests for adviser appointments rose 27% in 2025, while the average wait for a first appointment is 9 days. Clients who are offered an appointment within 2 days convert at more than twice the rate of those who wait longer.

Measure	2024	2025	2028 target
Share of sales completed digitally	15%	18%	35%
Digital applications abandoned after asking for support	46%	42%	20%
Average wait for a first adviser appointment (days)	11	9	2
Client satisfaction with advice (NPS)	28	31	45

2. Our strategy

The executive team has agreed one aspiration for the program: **to be the primary digital partner for our clients**. Four pillars support it, and together they are expected **to drive sustainable, profitable growth**.

1. **Digital-first advice.** Guided journeys in the app for everyday needs, with advisers available on video when a client needs a person.
2. **Simple, fair pricing.** One fee schedule across every channel, so clients pay the same whether they deal with us online or in person.
3. **Connected client data.** A single client view for every team, so advisers see what the client already did online and can offer the next best action in real time.
4. **Faster delivery.** Moving from quarterly to monthly releases, with one product team per client journey.

The pillars should be read as a whole: the aspiration sits above them, and profitable growth is the result of

delivering all four together.

3. Where the client journey breaks today

We mapped the inbound journey for two groups of clients. In both, the moment that decides the outcome is the hand-off from digital to a person. This is where clients either get an appointment or on-demand support quickly, or abandon.

Clients with simple needs

Little information needed and short tasks, such as opening an account or a savings product.

Step	What happens	Channel into this step
1. Research	Digital discovery of simple products and services	(start)
2. Self-serve	Client completes the task digitally without help	Digital self-serve (mobile / web)
3. Support needed	Client needs a person and cannot finish digitally	Digital self-serve (mobile / web)
4. Hand-off (the critical step)	Appointment booking or on-demand support offered in the app	Digital self-serve (mobile / web)
5. Adviser	A video or branch adviser completes the request	Video or in person

Clients with complex needs

More information needed and longer tasks, such as a mortgage or an investment plan.

Step	What happens	Channel into this step
1. Research	Digital discovery of complex products	(start)
2. Hand-off (the critical step)	Appointment booking or on-demand support offered in the app	Digital self-serve (mobile / web)
3. Adviser	A video or branch adviser builds the plan with the client	Video or in person

For discussion: are we aligned that the digital-to-adviser hand-off is the point to fix first?

4. Delivery plan, June 15 to September 25, 2026

The first phase runs for fifteen weeks, from June 15, 2026 to September 25, 2026. It ends with the full cut-over to the new hand-off experience.

Key milestones

Date	Milestone	Type
June 19, 2026	Business case approved	Milestone
July 6 to July 17, 2026	Vendor proposals due	Submission window
July 20 to August 7, 2026	Security review of the chosen vendor	Review window
August 14, 2026	Pilot go-live with 2,000 clients	Milestone
August 28 to September 4, 2026	Board paper submission	Submission window
September 21, 2026	Full cut-over	Milestone

Key deliverables

Due date	Deliverable
June 26, 2026	Target architecture
July 22, 2026	Test strategy
August 21, 2026	Pilot results report
September 18, 2026	Operations runbook

Steering committee meetings

Date	Focus	Topics
July 3, 2026	Mobilisation	Confirm scope and budget; agree the vendor shortlist
July 29, 2026	Design sign-off	Approve the target design; confirm data scope
August 12, 2026	Pilot readiness	Review security findings; approve pilot go-live

September 16, 2026	Cut-over decision	Pilot results and lessons; go or no-go for cut-over

5. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Adviser capacity cannot absorb faster appointment booking	Add video advisers before the pilot; cap pilot volumes at 2,000 clients
Client data is not connected in time for the pilot	Limit the pilot to products already on the single client view
Vendor security review takes longer than three weeks	Start the review on July 20 with two shortlisted vendors in parallel

6. Decisions requested

- Endorse the aspiration and the four pillars as the program strategy.
- Agree that the digital-to-adviser hand-off is the first priority.
- Approve the delivery plan and the four steering committee dates.